

Ricky Circelli

rickycircelli8@gmail.com
(904) 465-6804

rickycircelli.com
github.com/rickycircelli
linkedin.com/in/richardcircelli

EDUCATION

University of South Carolina

Bachelor of Science; Major: Finance (Darla Moore School of Business)
Second Major: Data Science (College of Arts & Sciences); GPA: 4.0

Columbia, SC
Aug. 2024 – May 2027

- **Honors and Involvement:** President’s List (4x), CSC Academic All-District Team, SEC Academic Honor Roll, South Carolina Honors College
- **Relevant Coursework:** Statistical Methods I & II, Computing for Data Science, Data Analytics, Applied Statistics, Corporate Financial Analysis, Finance, Accounting, Commercial Law, Operations Management, Information Systems, Calculus II, Algorithmic Design I
- **Certification:** IBM Data Science Professional Certificate (Python, SQL, Machine Learning, Data Visualization, Cloud Computing, Generative AI); Microsoft Power BI Data Analyst (PL-300); AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner; Claude Certified Architect (CCA-F)

INTERCOLLEGIATE ATHLETICS

University of South Carolina Men’s Track & Field

Student-Athlete

Columbia, SC
Aug. 2024 – Present

- Manage a full academic course load while training 25 hours per week as a mid-distance runner (800m, 1500m), including practice, competition, and travel

EXPERIENCE

Ally Financial

Quantitative Modeling Intern

Charlotte, NC
May 2026 - August 2026

- Built an end-to-end machine learning credit risk model for auto lending using 200,000+ loan applications and 2,000+ variables, developing the full modeling pipeline from raw data through model evaluation
- Engineered features, performed Information Value (IV) analysis, correlation reduction, and reject inference across booked and unbooked application populations to improve predictive performance
- Trained and evaluated XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, and Random Forest models using AUC, KS, log loss, calibration, and SHAP explainability

Varsity Stack

Founder

Columbia, SC
February 2026 - Present

- Building an AI-powered platform that helps teams manage athlete supplementation and amplifies nutritionists, integrating wearable and health data with large language models to deliver personalized recommendations
- Selected as a Top 5 Finalist in the SEC Startup Competition; reaching 1,000+ app downloads, onboarding 2 teams, and generating recurring subscription revenue

Dubin Clark

Private Equity Intern

Jacksonville, FL
June 2024 - July 2024

- Created one-pagers, diligence memos, and financial models in Excel; took notes during client calls

PROJECTS

AI Portfolio Optimizer - Independent Project

May 2025 - July 2025

- Built an AI-powered robo-advisor using Python, Plaid APIs, and Monte Carlo simulation to generate personalized ETF portfolios based on investor risk profiles
- Developed machine learning pipelines incorporating alternative financial data and generative AI to automate portfolio recommendations

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Gamecock Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

Active Member

November 2024 – Present

- Active member building machine learning models and participating in applied AI competitions

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, SQL, R
- **Machine Learning:** XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, Random Forest, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, SHAP
- **AI & LLMs:** OpenAI API, Claude API, Prompt Engineering, AI Agents, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)
- **Developer Tools:** Claude Code, Cursor, Git, GitHub, VS Code, Jupyter
- **Data:** Snowflake, Pandas, NumPy, Feature Engineering, ETL Pipelines
- **Analytics:** Credit Risk Modeling, Predictive Modeling, Information Value (IV), Reject Inference, Calibration, Monte Carlo Simulation, Statistical Analysis
- **Cloud & Platforms:** AWS, Supabase, Railway, Power BI, Excel